

B1

GRAMMAR LESSON · REPORTED SPEECH

Say vs Tell

say something, tell someone — and the fixed phrases with each.

Say - Tell Farkı

QUICK UNDERSTANDING

say ve **tell** ikisi de "söylemek" anlamına gelir ama farklı şekilde kullanılırlar. En önemli fark: **tell** genellikle kime söylendiğini belirten bir kişi (object) ister; **say** ise doğrudan kişi almaz, kişiyi belirtmek istersek "say to sb" şeklinde kullanılır.

The Structure

Formula

tell + kişi (+ that/wh-/to-infinitive)

say + (that)/söz (+ to + kişi)

Basit kural: tell'den sonra HEP bir kişi vardır (tell + SOMEONE). say'den sonra kişi varsa mutlaka "to" ile bağlanır (say + TO someone).

Affirmative / Negative / Question

Yapı	Kural	Örnek
tell + kişi	kişi zorunlu	She told her parents the news.
say + söz	kişi YOK	He said nothing.
say to + kişi	kişi 'to' ile	She said to her friend, "Good luck!"

Word Order

tell + kişi + (that-clause/wh-clause/to-infinitive) — say + (that-clause/söz) + (to + kişi)

- He **told** me a joke. — Bana bir fıkra anlattı.
- He **said** a few words **to** the crowd. — Kalabalığa birkaç söz söyledi.

How It Works

When do we use it?

- **tell + kişi**: kime söylendiği cümlede belirtiliyorsa. He told me a secret.
- **say + söz/ifade**: sadece ne söylendiği önemliyse, kime söylendiği belirtilmiyorsa. She said hello.
- **say to + kişi**: kime söylendiğini yine belirtmek istiyorsak ama "say" kullanmaya devam etmek istiyorsak. He said to me, "Wait here."
- **sabit ifadeler**: bazı ifadeler her zaman tell, bazıları her zaman say ile kullanılır — tell the truth, tell a lie, tell a story, tell the time / say yes, say no, say sorry, say goodbye.

When DON'T we use it?

say'den sonra doğrudan kişi (object) KULLANMA: say, tell gibi doğrudan bir kişi almaz.

✗ She said me that she was busy. → ✓ She told me that she was busy.

tell'i kişisiz KULLANMA: tell, kime söylendiğini belirtmeden kullanılamaz.

✗ He told that he was late. → ✓ He said that he was late. / He told me that he was late.

Short Answers

Hızlı kural: Cümlede kime söylendiği doğrudan (edatsız) belirtiliyorsa → tell. Belirtilmiyorsa ya da "to" ile belirtiliyorsa → say. tell the truth/a lie/a story/the time — say yes/no/sorry/goodbye kalıplarını ezberle.

Türkçe Mantığı

Zihninde şu sırayla ilerle:

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Bana gerçeği söyledi." → KİME SÖYLENDİĞİ BELLİ Mİ? → Evet, "bana" (me) belirtilmiş → İNGİLİZCEDE HANGİ FİİL? → tell (çünkü doğrudan bir kişi/object var: told ME) → CÜMLE → "She told me the truth."

Examples

TELL + KİŞİ

- She told me an interesting story about her trip. — Bana gezisiyle ilgili ilginç bir hikaye anlattı.
- Can you tell us what happened? — Bize ne olduğunu anlatabilir misin?
- He told the class to open their books. — Sınıfa kitaplarını açmalarını söyledi.

SAY (+ TO)

- She said she would be late. — Geç kalacağını söyledi.
- He said goodbye and left the room. — Vedalaştı ve odadan çıktı.
- What did she say to you at the meeting? — Toplantıda sana ne söyledi?
- He said to his colleagues, "Let's start the presentation." — Meslektaşlarına "Sunuma başlayalım" dedi.

SABİT İFADELER

- Always tell the truth, even when it's difficult. — Zor olsa bile her zaman doğruyu söyle.
- He told a lie to avoid getting in trouble. — Başı belaya girmesin diye yalan söyledi.
- Could you tell me the time, please? — Bana saati söyler misiniz lütfen?
- She said sorry for being late. — Geç kaldığı için özür diledi.

Compare & Notice

Compare With

Say / Tell

Genel, nötr aktarma fiilleridir; sadece "söylemek" anlamı taşırlar, ne söylendiğine dair ekstra bilgi vermezler.
He told me to leave.

İleri Düzey Aktarma Fiilleri

advise, warn, promise gibi fiiller, söylenenin TÜRÜNÜ de anlatır (tavsiye, uyarı, söz...) ve her biri farklı bir yapı ister.
He warned me to leave.

→ İleri Düzey Aktarma Fiilleri dersine git

Karar Şeması (Decision Guide)

Soru: Cümlede kime söylendiği doğrudan belirtiliyor mu?

EVET, DOĞRUDAN (KİŞİ HEMEN FİLDEN SONRA)

tell — He told me the news.

HAYIR / "TO" İLE BELİRTİLİYOR

say (to) — He said the news to me.

Common Mistakes

✗ She said me that she was tired.

✓ **She told me that she was tired.**

WHY? say, doğrudan bir kişi (object) alamaz; kişi belirtilecekse tell kullanılmalı, ya da "said TO me" denmeli.

✗ He told that he was busy.

✓ **He said that he was busy.**

WHY? tell kişisiz kullanılamaz; kişi belirtilmiyorsa say kullanılır.

✗ He told to his friend to wait.

✓ **He told his friend to wait.**

WHY? tell'den sonra kişi doğrudan (edatsız) gelir; "to" gereksizdir çünkü tell zaten kişiyi doğrudan alır.

✗ She said to me a lie.

✓ **She told me a lie.**

WHY? "tell a lie" sabit bir ifadedir ve her zaman tell ile kullanılır, say ile değil.

✗ Tell yes if you agree.

✓ **Say yes if you agree.**

WHY? "say yes/no" sabit bir ifadedir; tell ile kullanılmaz.

Practice

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 19

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. She _____ me that she was tired.

a) said

b) talked

c) told

d) spoke

2. He _____ that he was busy.

a) said

b) talked

c) told

d) spoke

3. Find the mistake and correct it.

She ^A said to me ^B a lie. ^C

Correction: _____

PART B · PRACTICE

4. Can you _____ me the time, please?

a) speak

b) talk

c) say

d) tell

5. Don't forget to _____ goodbye to your grandmother.

a) say

b) talk

c) tell

d) speak

6. Find the mistake and correct it.

He told ^A to his friend ^B to wait. ^C

Correction: _____

7. _____ yes if you agree. (Say / Tell)

8. Your friend didn't tell the truth. You are upset.

What do you say?

a) Why didn't you tell me the truth?

b) Why didn't you say the truth me?

c) Why didn't you say me the truth?

d) Why didn't you tell to me the truth?

9. "He said to me, 'Wait here.'" Is this correct?

a) No — it must be "said me".

b) No — say can never be used with a person.

c) No — it must be "told to me".

d) Yes — "say to + person" is correct.

10. My grandfather loves _____ stories about his childhood.

a) talking

b) speaking

c) saying

d) telling

PART C · FINAL CHECK

11. Could you _____ that again? I didn't hear you.

- a) speak it b) tell c) say d) tell me it

12. She _____ us to be quiet.

- a) spoke b) told c) said d) said us

13. He _____ a really funny joke at dinner. (tell, past)

14. Find the mistake and correct it.

She ^A said me ^B that she was leaving. ^C

Correction: _____

15. What did the teacher _____ about the exam?

- a) say b) tell c) tell to d) speak to

16. You broke your friend's cup.

What should you do?

- a) Tell sorry. b) Say to sorry. c) Tell her a sorry. d) Say sorry.

17. Which sentence is correct?

- a) He said a secret me.
b) He told me a secret.
c) He said me a secret.
d) He told to me a secret.

18. I can't _____ the difference between the twins.

- a) speak b) talk c) tell d) say

19. Rewrite with "told": "He said to me that he was sorry."

He _____ that he was sorry.

Answer Key

Kısa açıklamalar, her cevabın hangi kurala dayandığını gösterir.

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. **c) told** — Kişi (me) → told.
2. **a) said** — Kişi yok → said.
3. **B — said to me → told me** — tell a lie (sabit ifade): She told me a lie.

PART B · PRACTICE

4. **d) tell** — tell the time.
5. **a) say** — say goodbye.
6. **B — to his friend → his friend** — tell + kişi (to yok).
7. **Say** — say yes/no.
8. **a) Why didn't you tell me the truth?** — tell + kişi + the truth.
9. **d) Yes — "say to + person" is correct.** — say to + kişi doğru bir yapıdır.
10. **d) telling** — tell a story.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

11. **c) say** — Bir sözü tekrar etmek → say.
12. **b) told** — Emir aktarımı → tell + kişi + to.
13. **told** — tell a joke.
14. **B — said me → told me** — Kişi nesnesi → told.
15. **a) say** — Kişisiz → say.
16. **d) Say sorry.** — say sorry.
17. **b) He told me a secret.** — tell + kişi + şey.
18. **c) tell** — tell the difference (ayırt etmek).
19. **He told me that he was sorry.** — said to me = told me.

Bu dersin interaktif versiyonu (anında geri bildirimli alıştırımlar): <https://abonlinenglish.school/grammar/b1/say-vs-tell>